

5-min Google blackout

A blackout of Google and its services caused 40% dip in global Web traffic
<http://dgit.in/173LzPh>



Instagram's virus

The Zeus virus, once used to rob from U.S. banks, is running rampant on Instagram
<http://dgit.in/13QPAT1>

Touchscreen Laptops Test

promising improved processor architecture and better battery life. Given the slim profile, you obviously can't expect a powerful beast of a processor and



Dell Inspiron 15z with Touch

GPU to power this ultrabook. However, it does offer a fairly equipped Intel Core i5-4200U dual-core chip running at 1.60 GHz with a maximum turbo boost capability of 2.6 GHz on a single core and the on-die Intel HD Graphics 4400 GPU (15w max TDP combined) is barely a notch above the older HD 4000 series that did duty inside the previous Ivy Bridge platform. The 4GB on-board (soldered) RAM and 128GB SSD make for a fairly zippy machine. The boot-up time ranged anywhere between 8-12 seconds, which is way better than regular HDD laptops (that take 18-30 seconds to boot). The SSD logged an impressive average of 416 MB/s read and 191 MB/s write speeds. Having said that, Sony's decision to not use the PCI-e based SSD like the international variants of the Vaio Pro 13 is a major disappointment for performance junkies like us. PCI-e based SSDs can deliver read and write speeds in the range of 800 and 400 MB/s respectively which is screaming fast storage performance.

The Sony Vaio Pro 13 lasted a good 4.3 hours under heavy load (all four cores running at max, Wi-Fi on and screen brightness at 50%). In real-world sce-

narios, we managed a handsome 8 hours and 12 minutes of battery life with Wi-Fi on and brightness set at 50% over a regular work day scenario which involved browsing with 8-12 tabs along with office applications and light image editing. The Vaio Pro 13 largely manages to keep the thermals under check and the keyboard and the palm rest do not suffer from excessive

heating when the machine is under full load. But, the same cannot be said about the noise levels – max out the four cores and the fan noise is eminently obvious and irritating.

Dell Inspiron 15z with Touch (5523)

Dell has always carried forward the family resemblance between machines, and the same holds true for the upgrade from the Inspiron 15z to the Inspiron 15z Touch. The lid has the brushed metal finish, and that is carried around the keyboard deck as well. The sides have a light grey frame. Throughout, the finish is matte, and that is a huge positive if you do not like your laptop to adorn visible fingerprints, dust and scratches. Unlike the effort last year, this version has very good build quality, and all the panel flex issues have been ironed out neatly. However, while this is technically an ultrabook, the form factor thanks to the 15.6-inch display and the optical drive means it is closer to the conventional laptops.

While this is actually a Core i7 processor, the PC Mark 7 score is surprisingly lower than some other machines – 4862 that the Lenovo Yoga 13 scored and the 4734 that the Dell XPS 12 scored

– both machines powered by the Intel Core i5 – 3317U processor. This anomaly aside, the real world performance is significantly better than most other machines out there, when it comes to CPU intensive tasks. It is a surprise that Dell hasn't bumped up the graphics, which continues to be the NVIDIA GeForce GT630M (2GB). Considering that much lower priced machines have the GT635M now, we would expect this upgrade sooner rather than later.

The Inspiron 15z's display is also much improved over the previous generation's offering. For starters, it is brighter and the text rendering is much better, enabling crisper readability of words. Certain colours feel a tad washed out at brightness above 70%. However, that can be forgiven for a while, because despite being a reflective display, the better native brightness ensures you don't struggle with the environment reflecting off the screen.

For all this performance and the bigger display, battery life does take a bit of a hit. The Inspiron 15z lasted just two hours and 10 minutes in the battery benchmark test. While there are some machines that have fared a lot worse in the battery stakes, the Inspiron 15z, we would say, still does fairly alright in this department.

Lenovo ThinkPad Twist

We would not hold it against you if you thought the ThinkPad Twist and the X1 Carbon are the same, at least when the lid is closed and you don't notice the slightly different designed display hinge to enable the swivel screen – the 180 degree movement mechanism means the

screen can either be laid flat or can be twisted around (hence the name!) to fold down over the keyboard in what would be a sort of tablet mode. The hinge itself may feel somewhat flimsy at times, but looks can be deceptive and the solidity of the hinge is excellent. The keyboard deck is uncharacteristically populated for a ThinkPad machine, and the placement of the power key on the side of the display is another unique element. The soft feel matte finish is again rather similar to the finish on the much more expensive X1 Carbon.

Performance-wise, you do get the benefit of a fairly quick SSD and excellent battery life (140 minutes in the benchmark test) to make this a rather competent option for those looking for a business machine. The Samsung MZ7PC128HAFU solid state drive isn't as quick as the Toshiba THNSNH128NT in the VAIO Pro 13, but is almost as quick as the Samsung PM830 in the Dell XPS 12.

Lenovo IdeaPad Yoga 13

Lenovo has named this the Yoga for a reason – it can attain various positions that most ultrabooks cannot even dream of. And yes, the display does not come off like on some devices. Unlike the swivel mechanism like the Twist, the Yoga 13 has a



Lenovo IdeaPad YOGA 13